Hampstead Heath
Registered Charity

Fees and Charges 2027-28: Swimming

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Sustainable swimming for the future

The Bathing Ponds and Lido are part of what makes Hampstead Heath so special.

- Hubs to promote community health and wellbeing
- Open throughout the year
- Accessible to swimmers with different needs
- Lifeguarded, tested, cleaned and maintained
- Facing multiple and complex challenges including - rising costs, increased use, increased need for security and aging facilities
- Unique setting preserved in perpetuity by Hampstead Heath Charity with the City of London Corporation as trustee.

Our task: to protect this much-loved provision for future generations while keeping swimming accessible.



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Why the current approach needs to change

- Fees and charges are essential income. They are not set at full cost recovery, but they do need to be set at a sustainable level.

- Hampstead Heath charges are comparatively low:
  - An adult swim is currently £5, compared with a benchmark average of £8.29
  - Our annual swimming season ticket currently pays for itself after only 31 swims, compared with an average of 61 swims at similar venues

- Hampstead Heath receives no income from local taxes or levies

We have a duty to ensure Hampstead Heath, as a charity, is sustainable.



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A comprehensive review, not simply a price increase

Our proposal combines sustainability with stronger support for access and more options for regular swimmers

- Increase the concessionary discount from **40%** to **50%**
- Protect free morning swimming for under-16s and people aged 60+
- Continue free entry for carers
- Introduce new monthly rolling tickets to spread the cost, cancel at any time.
- Retain six- and 12-month options
- Annual season tickets represent the cost of 48 swims (swim just once a week and benefit)
- Restore the **30% discount** for combined Lido + Ponds Season Ticket
- New fees and charges phased in over two years



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A transparent pricing structure across the facilities

Using £7.50 adult swim as the foundation for pricing

Ticket type	Current Adult	Proposed Adult	Current Concession	Proposed Concession
Lido (off peak)	£5.00	£7.50	£3.00	£3.75
Lido (peak)	£8.80	£13.20	£5.20	£6.60
Ponds	£5.00	£7.50	£3.00	£3.75
Ponds Rolling Monthly Season (new)	N/A	£36	N/A	£18
Ponds Six-Month Season	£83	£198	£50	£99
Ponds Annual Season	£157	£360	£94	£180
Lido Rolling Monthly Season (new)	N/A	£40.50	N/A	£20.25
Lido Six-Month Season	£171	£223	£102	£111.50
Lido Annual Season	£252	£405	£152	£202.50
Combined Rolling Monthly Season (new)	n/a	£53.50	n/a	£26.75
Combined Six-Month Season	£216	£295	£130	£148
Combined Annual Season	£348	£536	£209	£268



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Timeframe for proposal and implementation

The review of the pricing structure for swimming at Hampstead Heath will result in prices increasing above inflation, but remaining below benchmarked comparable venues.

- Accessibility remains central to the Charity's objectives - with free swims protected and concession rates strengthened.
- At this stage, this proposal is for swimming association committee members only.
- We invite representations through a consolidated response from the swimming association committee members by email to Charlotte Williams two weeks prior to the Sports and Wellbeing Forum,

15 Dec	Proposal to the Sports and Wellbeing Forum
12 Jan	Proposal to the Hampstead Heath Consultative Committee
2 Feb	Proposal to the HHHWQPC

